

LESSON 102: DEFENSE – FIGB COUNT AND SUIT PREFERENCE

1. COUNTING THE CARDS

METHOD	WHAT TO DO	EXAMPLE	MEANING
HIGH-LOW (8 then 3)	Play a HIGH card first, then a LOWER card.	8♠ → 3♠	EVEN number of cards
LOW-HIGH (3 then 8)	Play a LOW card first, then a HIGHER card.	3♠ → 8♠	ODD number of cards

2. SEQUENCES TAKE PRECEDENCE OVER COUNT



→ Play Q

A sequence is more important than count.



→ Play 10

A sequence is more important than count.

3. SUIT PREFERENCE SIGNAL



HIGH card = **HIGHER** ranking suit
prefer the



LOW card = **LOWER** ranking suit
prefer the

4. WHEN to give COUNT



When partner has already decided what to do in the suit.

5. WHEN to give SUIT PREFERENCE



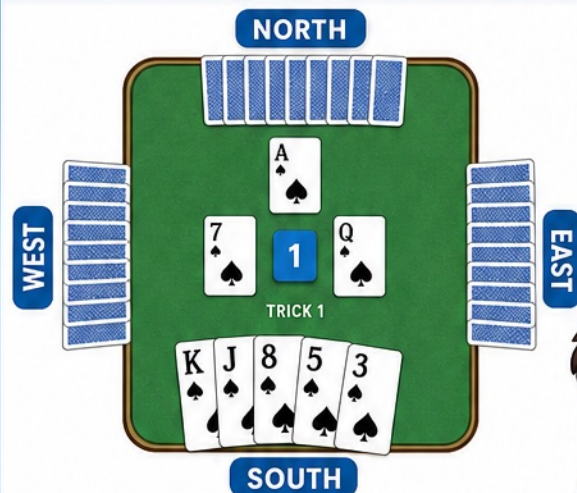
When partner needs to choose which suit to play.

6. CAUTION



Do not give **COUNT** when it only helps the declarer!

7. PRACTICAL EXAMPLE: DEFENDER CHOOSING WHICH CARD TO PLAY



Partner (East) led the Queen of Spades. I must decide which card to play.



If I play **HIGH** (8), I prefer the **HIGHER** ranking suit for partner to continue.



If I play **LOW** (3), I prefer the **LOWER** ranking suit for partner to continue.

Right now, partner needs to choose a suit, so I can give **SUIT PREFERENCE** with my card.



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